Santiago Diaz Ola

QA Engineer | Behavioral Specialist

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Professional Summary

QA Engineer & Behavioral Specialist with 4 years of experience in software quality assurance and over 10 years of expertise in systemic analysis and behavioral observation. I specialize in **Risk-Based Testing** and **Behavioral Edge-Case Discovery**, viewing software as a critical bridge between complex technical architectures and human reliability. I perform **Root Cause Analysis (RCA)** to identify the systemic triggers of failure, anticipating unpredictable user paths that automated scripts often miss. I am dedicated to building resilient, secure, and human-centric software that prioritizes data integrity and seamless user conversion.

Technical Skills & Core Competencies

Technical QA Stack

- **Methodologies:** Agile/Scrum, Regression, Boundary Value Analysis (BVA), i18n (Internationalization) & UTF-8 Validation, E2E Testing.
- **Tools:** TestRail, Jira, Trello, Postman, Git/GitHub, Browser DevTools (Network/Console).
- **Analysis:** Root Cause Analysis (RCA), API Functional Validation, Frontend Logic Inspection, Cross-Browser Testing (Chrome/Safari).
- **Exploratory Testing:** Utilizing a "charter-based" approach to uncover edge cases in complex user workflows, merging technical intuition with behavioral risk analysis.
- **SDLC & STLC:** Full-lifecycle involvement from requirement analysis and test planning to defect closure and final reporting.

Behavioral & Strategic Quality

- **Heuristic Evaluation:** Applying clinical-grade observation to identify systemic friction in user acquisition flows.
- **UX Risk Assessment:** Analyzing error messaging impact on user retention, brand trust, and cognitive load.
- **Market-Specific Validation:** Identifying market blockers for LATAM and EMEA segments through linguistic and cultural testing.

Professional Experience

QA Engineer | Globant [*2022* – Present]

- **Core Focus:** Delivering end-to-end quality assurance for high-stakes digital transaction and payment solutions.
- **Test Execution:** Design and execute comprehensive functional, regression, smoke, and **E2E tests** for web applications.
- **Documentation & Planning:** Own the full testing lifecycle, including strategic **Test Planning**, detailed **Test Case documentation**, and requirement traceability.
- **Technical Validation:** Conduct rigorous database testing and backend validation to ensure data integrity and transaction security.
- **Agile Collaboration:** Partner closely with developers and product owners in **Scrum/Agile** environments to refine requirements and support rapid release cycles.

Projects & Technical Audits

- **National Healthcare Service (NHS) API Audit**
  - **Project Scope:** Technical Audit of the UK's National Healthcare **Data Infrastructure**. Patient Search & Retrieval.
  - **The Work:** Technical audit of sensitive healthcare endpoints to ensure data integrity and security compliance within the **SDLC**.

    - **The Technical Win:** Built a functional testing suite in **Postman** to validate payload logic, status codes, and security headers.
    - **Project Governance:** Managed technical debt and sprint backlogs using **Jira** within a high-compliance **Agile environment**.
    - **Stack:** Postman/Newman, Jira, Git, API Documentation.
- **Hilton Honors Web Quality Audit**
    - **The Work:** Executed a full-lifecycle manual audit of global reservation and registration flows.
    - **The Technical Win:** Diagnosed a **P1 i18n blocker** affecting non-ASCII user registration using Chrome DevTools for client-side Root Cause Analysis (RCA).
    - **The Behavioral Win:** Performed **Exploratory Testing** and **Heuristic Evaluations** to identify UX friction points and market-specific barriers for LATAM users.
    - **Stack:** TestRail, Trello, Browser DevTools, RTM.

Education & Certifications

- **B.A. in Psychology** | National University of San Luis (UNSL)
- **English for Professional Purposes** | Hunter College, New York City
- **Software QA Training** | Specialized focus on Manual, API, and Automation Testing (Postman, Jira, JavaScript & PlayWright).

Let's Connect

I am currently seeking opportunities where I can apply my technical QA rigor and behavioral expertise to build high-quality, user-centric software.